

## Chapter 155-4

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When the filming of "Mo Xin Tu Mo"<sup>1</sup> was halfway through, all the scenes in the mansion had been completed, and the entire crew changed locations to the city outskirts, where there was a place specifically for filming Republic era<sup>2</sup> dramas.

After changing locations, it was too far from Xu Qingzhu's company, and Liang Shi's scenes would wrap up in just one more week.

So Xu Qingzhu went back home to stay.

The days on set were very ordinary, just like many days before.

Gu Yixue would arrange everything in an orderly manner, putting in the most effort.

Fortunately, all the staff had been trained and tempered by Gu Yixue. They could understand what Gu Yixue wanted with just a single glance.

Being able to cultivate such rapport was truly rare.

However, it was visibly obvious that Gu Yixue was smoking more and more frequently.

Before filming started, Gu Yixue wasn't so dependent on cigarettes. The further into filming they got, the greater the pressure became—one pack a day was considered little.

If there were many scenes to film and the days were long, she would concentrate her smoking at night.

Liang Shi had seen her many times.

She would stand alone in a corner, like a phantom of the night, her figure lonely and desolate.

Facing the wall, she would light a cigarette, smoke it unhurriedly, then throw the cigarette butt into the trash can.

Afraid others would smell it, she would take out perfume and spray some on her sleeve cuffs.

Later, Liang Shi would invite her to eat late-night snacks, but Gu Yixue would drink and smoke at the same time.

Though she smoked less.

Liang Shi asked her what was troubling her.

Gu Yixue paused. At first, she answered that it was the pressure.

Later, when she had drunk too much, she said somewhat incoherently: "An annoying pest is coming."

When drunk, Gu Yixue had no defenses up, though her gaze remained cold.

Liang Shi helped her back to the hotel, then returned to her own room.

Where Liang Shi couldn't see, Sun Chengcheng hid in a corner and took a photo.

Staring at the photo on her phone, Sun Chengcheng quickly returned to her room.

The annoying pest Gu Yixue mentioned soon arrived at the crew. At first, Liang Shi didn't know—she was rehearsing with Qi Tang at the time, discussing how to act the next scene.

Then she saw someone standing there gracefully asking: "Is Director Gu Yixue here?"

Gu Yixue was holding the script in her hand. She glanced at her once before looking away.

The newcomer wore a moon-white qipao^3^ with a white long coat on the outside. On her wrist was a jade bangle, translucent throughout—it looked quite valuable.

Her arrival pressed a pause button on the entire crew; everyone looked over in unison.

"Continue." Gu Yixue said coldly, and only then did everyone resume working.

Gu Yixue stood up and walked over, handing the script she had been flipping through to her. She said flatly: "Not many lines, just one dance. You can do it, right?"

The other person nodded: "Yes."

When she smiled, she had a dimple, looking dignified and elegant, gentle and amiable.

Qi Tang couldn't help but look a few more times. Liang Shi had to call her several times to bring her soul back. "What are you doing?"

Qi Tang giggled: "Sorry, Teacher Liang."

"It's fine." Liang Shi also glanced at that person and guessed: "This should be the actress responsible for performing the water sleeve dance."

Qi Tang nodded: "Probably. You can tell from her figure that she can dance."

She paused mid-sentence. "But it feels like Director Gu really doesn't like her."

"It's alright," Liang Shi said. "Doesn't Director Gu always have that expression?"

Just then, Gu Yixue came over. Qi Tang immediately stopped talking, like an elementary school student caught badmouthing someone by their homeroom teacher.

Gu Yixue didn't speak much with that person and didn't even arrange anything for her. She directly called Liang Shi and Qi Tang to perform the next scene.

All the crew members returned to their positions and continued filming.

It wasn't until the morning scenes were finished and it was lunch break that Gu Yixue went to talk to that person.

But her expression still wasn't good. She only said two or three sentences before leaving to smoke.

Liang Shi grabbed an extra boxed meal and went to find Gu Yixue, handing it to her.

Gu Yixue glanced at her: "What?"

"You can't eat cigarettes for meals." Liang Shi pushed the boxed meal toward her. "You won't live long like this."

Gu Yixue: "..."

She stubbed out her cigarette and waved her hand to disperse the smoke. "If I only heard the first half of what you said, I'd think you liked me."

Liang Shi was stunned: "?"

Gu Yixue took the boxed meal. "Just joking."

Liang Shi let out a breath of relief. "You scared me."

"You and your wife have such a good relationship." Gu Yixue smiled lightly. "I wouldn't go so far as to break you two up."

Liang Shi: "..."

Occasionally when Xu Qingzhu was mentioned, Liang Shi felt a bit embarrassed.

But her heart was quite sweet.

The two of them found a random place to sit, unwrapped their chopsticks, and ate the boxed meals.

Gu Yixue pushed the rice and vegetables around in the box several times back and forth, but only ate a few bites.

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## Footnotes:

1. "Mo Xin Tu Mo" (心途): The title of the drama being filmed. It can be translated as "Journey of the Heart" or "Heart's Path."
2. Republic era (民國): Refers to the Republic of China period (1912-1949), a popular setting for Chinese historical dramas featuring the early modern period of Chinese history.
3. Qipao (旗袍): A traditional Chinese dress also known as cheongsam, characterized by a high collar, fitted waist, and side slits. It became particularly fashionable during the Republic era.